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Gabriel takes round one

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Democrat Jesse Gabriel won 32 percent of the vote in the April 3 special election for the California Assembly's 45th district.

Matt Dababneh represented the district until he stepped down in January after being accused of sexual harassment.

The 45th District includes the western San Fernando Valley, Hidden Hills and Calabasas.

But Gabriel, an attorney, will not be the district's new representative. Unlike in a regular election, a special election candidate needs more than 50 percent of the vote to win.

Voters will choose between Gabriel and the next leading candidate, 19-year-old Justin Clark, in a runoff election June 5 to determine who will fill the remainder of Dababneh's term, which ends Dec. 3. The winner will be the favorite to fill the seat's full two-year term in a separate election also being held June 5.

Clark, a student at California State University, Northridge, received 27 percent of Tuesday's vote. Of the eight candidates on the ballot, he was the only Republican.

—Acorn staff report

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